

Wi-Fi 7 & the 6GHz home upgrade

If 2026 feels “laggy”, it might not be your phone – it might be your Wi-Fi. We often blame our devices for stuttering performance, but the network infrastructure is frequently the real culprit. Wi-Fi 7’s big trick is speed with stability: ultra-wide 320MHz channels in 6GHz, plus Multi-Link Operation (MLO) that can use multiple bands together to cut latency and reduce drop-outs. Think of MLO as a car being able to drive on two highway lanes simultaneously to avoid traffic jams. Add 4096-QAM packing more data into every signal, and it’s tailor-made for what Indian homes are becoming: a dense ecosystem of multiple 4K streams, cloud gaming, video calls, smart cameras, and the first wave of XR headsets. The Wi-Fi Alliance is already certifying

devices under Wi-Fi CERTIFIED 7, which should improve real-world cross-brand compatibility, ensuring your router plays nice with all your gadgets. India’s twist remains a critical factor: 6GHz availability matters. TRAI consultations and policy moves around delicensing the lower 6GHz band (5925–6425 MHz) are key to unlocking the “real” Wi-Fi 7 experience here, as that spectrum acts as a dedicated fast lane free from legacy interference. Buying tip: if you’re upgrading broadband or mesh in 2026, choose Wi-Fi 7 for future-proofing — it is the foundation your smart home needs — then enjoy the boost as your next phone/laptop catches up. Bonus: it’s backward compatible, so your older gadgets will still be able to connect without facing any issues.

Battery and charging are getting interesting

Phone innovation often looks flashy on the stage – dazzling screens, absurd zoom capabilities, and AI tricks – but what people really want is very simple: a battery that genuinely lasts longer and charges that doesn’t feel like a chore. In 2026, that’s where some of the most meaningful upgrades are landing – not as one magic breakthrough, but as two practical shifts.

Firstly, silicon-carbon batteries. This technology is finally stepping out of the lab and into the mainstream. Compared to traditional lithium-ion designs, silicon-carbon approaches can drastically improve energy density – which often

translates to either longer battery life in the same size, or similar battery life in a slimmer phone. It essentially solves the compromise between form factor and endurance, which is critical as foldable phones try to shed bulk. Brands have already been very publicly leaning into this as a direction for the next generations of smartphones.

Secondly, Qi2 magnetic wireless charging will become more ubiquitous. Qi2 basically brings the “snap-on” convenience that made MagSafe popular into a broader standard – better alignment, more reliable charging, fewer “why is it not charging?” moments on your desk. By using magnets to position the coils perfectly every time, it also reduces

the heat buildup caused by misalignment, which is better for long-term battery health. And it’s increasingly being framed as the year Android wireless charging could finally feel less messy and more predictable.

For India, both trends hit home: we keep phones longer, we stress batteries harder, and we love accessories that just work. With the widespread adoption of 5G and heavy daily consumption of video content, Indian users need devices that can survive a full day without nursing the battery percentage. A small bump in battery practicality can be more life-changing than a big bump in benchmark bragging.

The bigger picture

If you step back, 2026 tech has one clear mood: practical futurism. It represents a maturity in the industry where the “wow factor” must be matched by the “why factor. Yes, we’re getting sci-fi gadgets – foldables, smart glasses, AI assistants that feel like helpers instead of toys. But we’re also demanding basics: fair pricing, expandable storage, security, repairability, transparency, and longevity.

The future is arriving. We’re just insisting it arrives in a way that doesn’t make us feel like unpaid beta testers for expensive, unfinished tech. **d**

